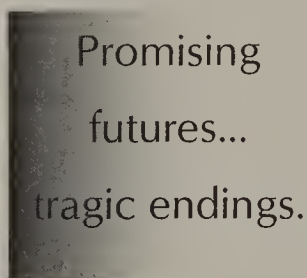


students now graduate with huge student loans and heavy credit card debt. It is not a coincidence that 25% of all bankruptcies these days are filed by young people under the age of 25. That, to me, seems like a crime, but no one is being held accountable. The credit card issuers and the federal government just look the other way.

Take, for example, twin brothers, age eighteen. Alex goes to college and is handed a credit card at his university. He is allowed a card just because he is a student. Zach decides to wait a year before going to college. He works full-time and when he applies for a credit card, he is denied because he has no credit history. Zach could pay his bill, so the credit card companies do not want him. In the nonsense upside-down world of credit cards, that is how it works with giving credit to young people these days.

Firing Back

It is often said that debt is the one issue in this country that touches everyone. Debt doesn't discriminate. Maybe that is because the credit card companies are going out of their way to get their paws on everyone. College kids never used to be targeted for credit cards. That was ludicrous. And poor people? Come on, get serious. And bending over



Promising
futures...
tragic endings.

backward to give cards to illegal aliens? What are you thinking? A decade or two ago, these groups of "consumers" were not aimed at by the financial lending industry and they, the consumers, were better off because of it. Now, everyone is fair game; except the game itself isn't fair.

Most parents have no idea that their kids are getting these credit cards and are shocked when they learn how much debt has piled up. Usually, it is the parents who come to their aid, helping their children pay off the balances. The credit card issuers know this, and literally bank on it. Sadly, it is not always the case. In the movie *Maxed Out*, two mothers told their stories. These two mothers did not know each other previously. One had a son; one had a daughter. The two students went to different colleges, and are a sobering example of what is happening on campuses throughout the United States.